Political Manifesto & Doctrine of Paul Andrew Turner Jr., J.M., M.S.

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My Statement on Israel, Palestine, and Mutual Accountability

I demand a foreign policy rooted in mutual accountability.

I recognize that the Israeli-Palestinian conflict is driven by entrenched extremism on multiple fronts. The terrorism of Hamas—including the massacre of October 7, 2023, which killed over a thousand Israeli civilians—and the destabilizing proxy warfare of Iranian-backed militants are undeniable drivers of regional violence. I condemn them without reservation. But moral clarity does not mean moral selectivity. The United States must have the geopolitical discipline to hold its allies to the same standard of international law it demands of its adversaries.

I unequivocally condemn the extreme ethnonationalist movements within Israel—including the settler violence organizations and far-right political factions now embedded in the Israeli governing coalition—that have systematically driven the theft of Palestinian land and perpetrated violence against Palestinian civilians under the protection of the Israeli Defense Forces. Acknowledging the actions of the IDF and the Israeli government in facilitating or compounding these abuses is not anti-ally; it is a prerequisite for reality-based diplomacy. A friend who watches you destroy yourself in silence is not a friend—they are an accomplice.

I believe in the immediate end to illegal settlements and a framework for restitution.

A lasting peace and a viable two-state reality cannot exist while territory is being actively expropriated. I believe that Israeli settlers must completely withdraw from the West Bank and all universally recognized Palestinian territories, consistent with

the pre-1967 borders as modified by mutually agreed land swaps—the baseline that every serious peace framework since Oslo has acknowledged as the starting point for negotiation.

Furthermore, accountability cannot be merely rhetorical; it must be structural and financial. The Israeli government must be held responsible for providing restitution for the expropriation of land, the destruction of homes and civilian infrastructure, and the documented killings of Palestinian civilians resulting from settlement enforcement and settler violence. I am specific about scope: I am not demanding reparations for the totality of the conflict's casualties; I am demanding that a government which permitted, funded, and militarily protected an illegal colonization project pay for the material damage that project inflicted. This is not punitive—it is the minimum standard of accountability that international law has applied to occupying powers since the Fourth Geneva Convention.

I demand a plan for Gaza's reconstruction and political future.

No credible peace framework can ignore the catastrophic destruction of the Gaza Strip. The military campaigns of 2023–2025 reduced vast portions of Gaza's civilian infrastructure—hospitals, schools, water treatment facilities, residential neighborhoods—to rubble. Over two million people have been subjected to conditions that the International Court of Justice and multiple UN agencies have described as a humanitarian catastrophe. I refuse to accept a political settlement that treats this devastation as a footnote.

I advocate for a comprehensive, internationally funded Gaza Reconstruction and Transition Framework, structured around three pillars:

- **Reconstruction:** A Marshall Plan–scale international reconstruction effort, administered by the United Nations Relief and Works Agency (UNRWA) in coordination with vetted international development partners, with transparent, auditable disbursement of funds. The United States, as the primary military patron of the campaign that caused the destruction, has a moral obligation to be the leading financial contributor to this effort.
- **Governance Transition:** I reject both the reimposition of Israeli military occupation and the return of Hamas governance. I support a UN-administered transitional authority—modeled on the frameworks used in Kosovo and East Timor—tasked with providing interim governance, rebuilding civil institutions, and

preparing for free, internationally monitored elections within a defined timeline. The people of Gaza must ultimately choose their own leadership, but they cannot do so from rubble.

- **Security Guarantees:** A multinational peacekeeping presence—drawn from regional and international partners, not from the belligerents—must be established to guarantee civilian safety during the transition period. Israel's legitimate security concerns regarding rocket attacks must be addressed through demilitarization protocols and international monitoring, not through a permanent blockade that punishes an entire civilian population for the actions of militant factions.

I advocate for Jerusalem as an international city.

Jerusalem is a city of unmatched historical, cultural, and spiritual significance to multiple faiths and peoples. It is sacred to Judaism, Christianity, and Islam. It is claimed as a capital by both Israelis and Palestinians. Because of its unique global weight, it cannot be governed exclusively by a single ethnonationalist or religious mandate without perpetual conflict. I believe the only durable, equitable solution is for Jerusalem to be recognized as an international city—a *Corpus Separatum*—administered and overseen by the United Nations. This structural shift would guarantee equal access, security, and administrative neutrality for all who live and worship within its borders.

I am not naive about the difficulty of this proposal. The *Corpus Separatum* framework was originally envisioned in the 1947 UN Partition Plan and was rejected by all parties before the ink was dry. No version of the UN Security Council as currently constituted is likely to agree on its implementation, given the veto dynamics that have paralyzed Middle East diplomacy for decades. I accept this political reality, but I refuse to let the difficulty of a solution become an argument for the permanence of injustice. The path to Jerusalem's internationalization will require a level of diplomatic ambition and sustained multilateral commitment that does not currently exist—but that is an argument for building that commitment, not for abandoning the principle.

On the question of residency: all current residents of Jerusalem—Israeli, Palestinian, and otherwise—must retain full civil and political rights under the international framework, including the right to remain in their homes, to vote in the city's municipal governance, and to maintain their respective national

citizenships. The goal is not displacement; it is the depoliticization of a city that has been weaponized by competing nationalisms for nearly a century.

I believe American military aid must be conditional on compliance with international law.

I reiterate and sharpen the position stated in my broader foreign policy doctrine: the United States can and should aid in the legitimate defense of Israel and its people. I support the continued funding of defensive systems such as Iron Dome that protect Israeli civilians from rocket attacks. What I refuse to support is the unconditional provision of billions in military funding that is then used to underwrite offensive operations, settlement expansion, the bombardment of civilian infrastructure, or the enforcement of an indefinite occupation.

I advocate for the passage of a federal *Leahy Law Enhancement Act* that strengthens existing human rights vetting requirements for all US security assistance—closing the loopholes that have allowed successive administrations to waive compliance for politically favored allies. If a unit of any foreign military has committed gross violations of human rights with American weapons, American funding to that unit ends. No exceptions. No waivers. No blank checks disguised as strategic partnerships.

My Statement on Iran and Diplomatic Realism

I believe we must acknowledge our historical accountability.

I believe we cannot resolve the crisis with Iran without acknowledging our historical role in creating it. The United States and the United Kingdom bear direct responsibility for the trajectory of modern Iran. In 1953, American and British intelligence agencies orchestrated the overthrow of Prime Minister Mohammad Mosaddegh—a democratically elected leader—because he had the audacity to nationalize Iran's oil industry and assert sovereignty over his own country's natural resources. In his place, Western powers installed and sustained the autocratic rule of Shah Mohammad Reza Pahlavi, whose secret police, the SAVAK, became synonymous with torture, political disappearance, and the systematic crushing of dissent.

This is not ancient history. It is the direct causal chain that produced the 1979 revolution, the rise of the Islamic Republic, and the anti-American grievance that has animated Iranian politics for nearly half a century. For decades since, rather than attempting to normalize relations or empower the Iranian people's own democratic aspirations, US administrations have largely chosen to ratchet up sanctions, fund opposition groups, and treat Iran as an irredeemable enemy. I do not excuse the brutality of the Islamic Republic—its theocratic repression, its support for proxy militias, its persecution of women and minorities—but I insist that honest diplomacy begins with honest history. You cannot lecture a nation about the rules of the international order while pretending you did not overthrow their government when they tried to follow those rules.

I support the JCPOA framework and verifiable nuclear nonproliferation.

I am an uncompromising advocate for global nuclear nonproliferation. I also recognize that sovereign nations, including Iran, have a right to civilian nuclear energy under the Nuclear Non-Proliferation Treaty. These two principles are not

in conflict—they are the basis upon which the Obama administration's Joint Comprehensive Plan of Action (JCPOA) was built. The JCPOA was the most rigorous, verifiable nuclear containment framework ever negotiated with a non-ally. It imposed severe restrictions on Iran's enrichment capacity, subjected its facilities to the most intrusive inspection regime in the history of the International Atomic Energy Agency, and provided a structured pathway for Iran to rejoin the international economic community in exchange for compliance.

The Trump administration's withdrawal from the JCPOA in 2018 was not an act of strength; it was an act of strategic vandalism. It removed the best structural tool the international community had for containing Iran's nuclear ambitions, isolated the United States from its own European allies who remained party to the agreement, and handed Iranian hardliners the proof they needed that American promises cannot survive a single election cycle. Every escalation since—Iran's resumed enrichment, the collapse of diplomatic trust, and the march toward the war we are now living through—flows from that decision.

I condemn the 2026 war as a catastrophic and unjustifiable escalation.

On February 28, 2026, the United States and Israel launched surprise airstrikes on multiple sites and cities across Iran. The opening salvo assassinated Supreme Leader Ali Khamenei, along with members of his family and numerous government officials. This was not the culmination of a military campaign—it was the first act: the deliberate killing of a head of state in a surprise first strike, an act that the international legal community has overwhelmingly condemned. The war that followed has killed well over a thousand Iranian civilians, hundreds in Lebanon, and American service members whose sacrifice I honor even as I condemn the decision that put them in harm's way. Service members do not choose their wars; their commanders do.

What makes this war not merely reckless but unconscionable is its timing. On February 27—the day before the strikes began—Oman's Foreign Minister publicly announced that a diplomatic

breakthrough had been reached. Iran had reportedly agreed to never stockpile enriched uranium and to submit to full IAEA verification—the core demand of every nonproliferation framework the United States has pursued for two decades. Peace was, by the mediator's own account, within reach. The United States and Israel chose to launch a war instead. This was not preemption born of necessity; it was a choice to destroy a diplomatic solution in favor of a military one, made by leaders who had already demonstrated their contempt for negotiated outcomes.

The consequences have been immediate and devastating. Iran has retaliated with missile and drone strikes across the Gulf region, hitting targets in Saudi Arabia, Kuwait, the UAE, and Israel. The Strait of Hormuz—through which approximately one-fifth of the world's crude oil flows—has been effectively closed by Iranian mining operations and naval confrontation, triggering a global energy crisis that is driving inflation, forcing developing nations to ration power, and punishing the very working families that this manifesto pledges to protect. The administration that launched this war had, by its own Congressional critics' assessment, no plan to reopen the strait. The human cost is staggering. The economic cost is global. And the strategic cost—the destruction of American credibility as a negotiating partner—may take a generation to repair.

I believe the United States has an obligation to account for the destruction it has caused.

My doctrine of Universalist Realism does not permit me to demand that Israel pay restitution for the destruction of Palestinian infrastructure while remaining silent about American bombs falling on Iranian hospitals, water treatment plants, and UNESCO World Heritage Sites. The same standard applies. If the United States has destroyed civilian infrastructure in Iran—and the evidence from the World Health Organization, the International Committee of the Red Cross, and independent journalism overwhelmingly indicates that it has—then the United States has a legal and moral obligation to participate in the reconstruction of what it destroyed.

I support the establishment of a congressionally authorized *Iranian Civilian Reconstruction Fund*, financed through a dedicated allocation within the defense budget, to provide humanitarian assistance and infrastructure reconstruction to Iranian civilians harmed by American military operations. This is not charity; it is the cost of the war. A nation that can afford to build the bombs can afford to rebuild what those bombs destroyed. To do otherwise is to confirm every accusation that American power is wielded without accountability—and to guarantee that the next generation of Iranians has every reason to see us as their enemy.

I demand a return to diplomacy, economic integration, and a durable peace framework.

The United States must pivot decisively away from military adventurism and commit to the hard, unglamorous, generational work of rebuilding diplomatic trust with Iran. This will not be easy. This war has shattered the credibility of American commitments and empowered the hardliners in Tehran who always argued that negotiation with Washington was futile. But the alternative—permanent war or permanent hostility with a nation of 90 million people sitting atop the world's most critical energy chokepoint—is not a strategy; it is a slow-motion catastrophe.

I advocate for the following specific diplomatic and economic framework:

- **Immediate Ceasefire and Humanitarian Corridor:** The United States must pursue an immediate, unconditional ceasefire and the establishment of humanitarian corridors for medical supplies, food, and clean water to Iranian civilians affected by the bombing campaign. This is a prerequisite for any subsequent diplomatic engagement.
- **Resumption of Mediated Negotiations:** I support the immediate resumption of negotiations through the Omani mediation channel that was producing results before it was destroyed by the February 28 strikes. Oman has served as a trusted intermediary for decades, and the diplomatic infrastructure it built must be restored, not abandoned.
- **A JCPOA Successor Agreement:** I support the negotiation of a comprehensive successor to the JCPOA—one that addresses nuclear enrichment, ballistic missile development, and regional proxy activity, while providing Iran with verifiable sanctions relief, economic integration pathways, and the security guarantees that the original agreement lacked. The failure of the JCPOA was not in its design but in the American decision to abandon it; the successor must include multilateral enforcement mechanisms that make it resistant to unilateral withdrawal by any single party.
- **Economic Integration as Strategic Architecture:** I reject the premise that sanctions alone produce democratic reform; decades of evidence suggest the opposite—sanctions entrench autocratic regimes by giving them an external enemy to blame while punishing the civilian population. I support a structured economic normalization framework—modeled on the approach that transformed post-Soviet Eastern

Europe—that ties incremental sanctions relief to specific, verifiable benchmarks: the release of political prisoners, the restoration of press freedoms, the cessation of support for designated terrorist organizations, and the acceptance of IAEA inspection protocols. The goal is not to reward the regime but to empower the Iranian people, who have repeatedly demonstrated—in the Green Movement of 2009, the Woman, Life, Freedom protests of 2022, and the January 2026 uprising—that they want a democratic future.

- **Strait of Hormuz International Freedom of Navigation Compact:** The effective closure of the Strait of Hormuz is an economic crisis that extends far beyond the Middle East. I support the negotiation of a multilateral freedom of navigation agreement—including the Gulf states, Iran, and the major trading nations whose economies depend on the strait—that guarantees unimpeded commercial transit, establishes a joint maritime monitoring mechanism, and removes the strait from the chessboard of bilateral military confrontation. The global economy cannot be held hostage to a single chokepoint, and the solution is diplomatic architecture, not perpetual naval standoff.

I recognize the complexity of Iran's post-Khamenei political landscape.

The assassination of Ali Khamenei has not produced the regime collapse that the architects of this war evidently expected. His son, Mojtaba Khamenei, has been installed as Supreme Leader, and hundreds of thousands of Iranians have rallied in support of the new leadership—not necessarily because they endorse theocratic rule, but because they have been given a war that unifies them against an external enemy. This is the oldest and most predictable consequence of military aggression against a sovereign nation: you do not liberate a people by bombing them. You radicalize them.

American diplomacy must engage with the Iranian government as it exists, not as we wish it to be. This does not mean endorsing the Islamic Republic's domestic repression or its regional proxy network. It means accepting the fundamental diplomatic reality that you negotiate peace with your adversaries, not with your friends, and that the precondition for engagement cannot be the prior capitulation of the other side. The Iranian people's struggle for democratic self-determination is their own; American foreign policy should support it through economic opportunity and diplomatic engagement, not through the barrel of a gun that has only succeeded in rallying the population behind the very regime we claim to oppose.

Strength Abroad. Justice at Home. The American Way.